

X. IŠTAR-LAMASSĪ AND HER DEATH (179-188)

The group of records presented in this chapter deals with events surrounding the death of Ištar-lamassī. She was a daughter of Elamma, as is stated in Kt 94/k 181 (courtesy C. Michel), where she seals an undated contract in which her sister Šalimma (the wife of Ir'am-Aššur) buys a slave. She was originally married to the Assyrian Kūn-ilum, with whom she had two sons, Iliya and Ilabrat-bāni, and a daughter, Šīmat-Ištar, who lived in Assur as *ugbaltu*-priestess. After Kūn-ilum's death she married the Anatolian Lullu, son of Hapi, and ten years later she died, almost immediately followed by the death of both her sons, which left her daughter in Assur as only heir. In the absence of sons, who would have been responsible for her funeral and the rites surrounding it, relatives and her second, Anatolian husband stepped in. He advanced the costs of her and her sons' funeral, but had to be indemnified (also for money he had earlier advanced on behalf of Iliya), which was done by taking the money from what Ištar-lamassī's sons would have inherited according to her last will. Relatives, Elamma's widow Lamassutum and his eldest son Ennam-Aššur, together with the representatives of her daughter, Šumi-abiya (called her *šazzutum*) and another Ennam-Aššur, and probably the men who had witnessed her last will (as its executors?) arranged this and ultimately sent what Šīmat-Ištar had inherited and what remained from the shares of her dead brothers to Assur.

These operations generated a number of records, such as letters sent to Assur to relate what happened, records of the transfer of money and assets, and accounts of the expenses and payments made, which turned up in Elamma's archive and provide us with a unique file. Unfortunately, there is no detailed report on the find-spots of the texts, whose excavation numbers suggest that they (or many of them) were found together and had been kept as a file. I studied this file in "The Death and Burial of Ištar-lamassī in *kārum* Kanish" (Veenhof 2008a), where texts *180, *184, *185 and *188 were already published. The present edition contains a few minor improvements in the reading of the texts, due to collation and the general comments at the end aim at a better understanding of the structure and meaning of the file and the function of the persons involved. I refer to my previous study for various details, especially for what these texts learn us about the funerary rites, such as the "bemoaning" of the dead and the removal of the chair of Ištar-lamassī. In the comments below I focus on the features that are relevant for the family history and the financial operations that conditioned how much of Ištar-lamassī's testamentary disposition could be realized.

179. Kt 91/k 453 (1-305-91)

The last will of Ištar-lamassī, unfortunately rather damaged, which makes it difficult to know which items of the property the individual heirs received.

<i>Ištar-lá-ma-[s]</i> <i>ší-im-t[a-ša]</i> <i>ta-ší-im-m[a i-na]</i> <i>1 ma-na LÁ 3 GÍN [KÙ.B.]</i> 5 <i>ša i-ba-ší-ú-[n]</i>	Ištar-lamassī made her will as follows: Of the 57 shekels of [silver] that are available,
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	$\frac{1}{2}$ <i>ma-na</i> °7 ₆ G[IN]	Iliya will take
	<i>l-lí-a i-lá-q[é]</i>	37 shekels;
	$\frac{1}{3}$ <i>ma-na</i> °NIN.ŠU[BUR]/-b[<i>a-ni</i>]	Ilabrat-bāni will take
	<i>i-lá-qé</i> 2 $\frac{1}{4}$ GÍN KÙ.G[I]	20 shekels; 2 $\frac{1}{4}$ shekels of gold
10	ù 7 $\frac{1}{2}$ GÍN KÙ.B. [ù]	and 7 $\frac{1}{2}$ shekels of silver
l.e.	<i>ku-nu-kam a-na</i> DUMU.MÍ-[<i>i-a</i>]	plus the seal one will send to
rev.	<i>gu₅-ba-ab-tim ú-šé-b[u-lu]</i>	my daughter who is a <i>gubabtu</i> -priestess.
	$\frac{1}{2}$ <i>ma-na</i> KÙ.B. ša [ø]	$\frac{1}{2}$ mina of silver for which
	É-tù <i>uk-[a-lu]</i>	the house is held (as security)
15	15 GÍN KÙ.B. * <i>a-l</i> °á ² -x x]	15 shekels of silver
	É-tù-ša <i>uk-[ta-lu]</i>	her house is held (as security),
	<i>tup-pu-šu-nu a-na [l-lí-a²]</i>	their tablets belong to [Iliya ²].
	<i>i-za-zu lu-q²ú-tum₆?</i>	The merchandise?.....
	ša <i>a-bi-šu-nu [a-na]</i>	of their father
20	<i>ki-lá-le-š[u-nu]</i>	belongs to two
	<i>i-za-zu *[D²-x x x]</i>	of them. With [.....]
	ša- <i>bu-a-at</i> °x x]	she is satisfied,
	<i>ta-lá-qé qá-á[b²*-li-tám]</i>	she will take. A <i>qablītu</i> -bowl
u.e.	ša 1 <i>ma-na [l-lí-a]</i>	weighing 1 mina [Iliya]
25	<i>i-lá-qé mu-š[a-lam]</i>	will take. The mirror
	ù <i>šu-ga-ri-[a-am]</i>	and the <i>šugarrium</i>
le.e.	°NIN.ŠUBUR- <i>ba-ni i-lá-qé</i>	Ilabrat-bāni will take.
	IGI <i>Ma-ši-i-lí</i> IGI <i>Puzur₄-lš[ta]</i>	In the presence of Maši-ilī, of
	IGI <i>En-um-A-šur</i>	Puzur-lštar, of Ennam-Aššur.

Notes

13-17. Twice a house “is held”, apparently as a pledge for a debt claim and I assume that “their tablets” are the contracts recording this fact and that the debts were owed to Ištar-lamassī or her husband. The testament assigns them most probably to Iliya, for his short name fits the gap and there follow items belonging to “both of them” (both brothers jointly).

18. The reading *lu-q[ú-tum]* is tentative and difficult in view of the verbal predicate in the masc. plural (*izzazū*) and because the father of the boys was long dead, but I see no alternative, also not when second sign is restored as MA or even DU. The reference must be to non-perishable items that had become Ištar-lamassī’s property and were now bequeathed to her sons.

21-23. The woman who is the subject of *šabbu’at*, “she is satisfied with", and presumably also of *talaqqe* is unknown, one would assume that it was Šīmat-lštar, but there is no room for her name or title (*gubabtum*). There could be a connection with *181:2, where the silver Šīmat-lštar gets from her mother derives from the latter’s *bābtum*, “outstanding claims”. The *qablītum* that Iliya acquired was probably a kind of metal bowl, two of which, each weighing 1 mina (of silver), were owned by Ištar-lamassī according to *186:4-5 (in l. 18 they occur alongside a mirror).

28-29. The three men probably were also the executors (*bēl šīmātīm*) of Ištar-lamassī’s testament; we meet them in other records of the file (*182:15-18, *185:1-6, *186:30, *187:1).

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A letter by family members in Kanesh to Šīmat-Ištar as main addressee (cf. I. 5, “your mother”) and to relatives living in Assur, among whom Lamassutum’s daughter Ummī-Išhara and a son-in-law, Ir’am-Aššur (married to Šalimma; see for him Ch. XI), to inform them of the death of Ištar-lamassī and her sons. This tablet must be a draft (note the mistakes in lines 6 and 21) or an archive copy kept in Kanesh.

	<i>um-ma Lá-ma-sà-tum Puzur₂-A-šūr</i>	Thus Lamassutum, Puzur-Aššur <and>
	<i>ù En-um-A-šur-ma a-na A-ta-a-/a</i>	Ennam-Aššur, say to Atāya,
	<i>Ir-ma-A-šur : Um-mi-Iš-ha-ra</i>	Ir’am-Aššur, Ummī-Išhara
	<i>ù Šī-ma-at-Ištar qí-bi₄-ma</i>	and Šīmat-Ištar:
5	<i>lá li-bi i-lim-ma : um-mi-ki</i>	“Unfortunately your ^{sing. fem.} mother
	<i>ù ki-lá-lá-ma : a-hu-ki : me-tù</i>	and both your brothers are dead.
	<i>i-na ba-áb : mu-wa-tim</i>	When your mother was
	<i>ša um-mi-ki 3 me-er-e</i>	on her deathbed, we seized
	<i>um-mi-a-ni : ni-iš-ba-at-ma</i>	three affiliated traders and
10	<i>a-na še-er : um-mi-ki</i>	brought them inside, to your
	<i>né-ru-ub-ma : IGI 3 me-er-e</i>	mother and in the presence of these
	<i>um-mi-a-ni : ta-ma-lá-ki-ša</i>	three affiliated traders your mother
	<i>Ištar-lá-ma-sí : um-mi-ki</i>	while she was still alive
	<i>i-na bu-ul-ṭi-ša-ma</i>	opened her coffer
15	<i>ta-ap-ṭù-ur-ma KÙ.B.</i>	and they saw every shekel
	<i>1 GÍN : i-šu : qá-tí-ša</i>	of silver, her cash property,
i.e.	<i>ša ib-ší-ú e-mu-ru-ma</i>	that there was and she then
	<i>2¼ GÍN GUŠKIN ù</i>	gave 2¼ shekels of gold and
	<i>8 GÍN KÙ.B. : a-na ku-a-tí</i>	8 shekels of silver to you.
rev.	<i>ta-dí-in ½ ma-na 7 GÍN</i>	37 shekels of silver she gave
21	<i>KÙ.B a-na Ì-lí-a : a-hi-ki(KÀ)</i>	to your brother Iliya,
	<i>ta-dí-in : ⅓ ma-na KÙ.B.</i>	20 shekels of silver
	<i>a-na ^dNIN.ŠUBUR-ba-ni</i>	she gave to Ilabrat-bāni.
	<i>ta-dí-in : i-na bu-lu-uṭ</i>	While you mother was still alive,
	<i>um-mi-ki-ma : lá-ma : a-na sí-kà-/tim</i>	before we left for the campaign,
25	<i>nu-úš-ú : Ì-lí-a : i-na</i>	Iliya was thrown
	<i>ki-ša-ar-ší-im : i-ni-dí</i>	into jail. After he had spent
	<i>iš-tù i-šu : qá-tí-šu : ig-mu-ru</i>	all he had available and (since)
	<i>ù nu-a-um : ša um-mi-ki : e-hu-zu</i>	Iliya was married with the daughter of
	<i>Ì-lí-a : me-er-a-sú : a-hi-iz</i>	the Anatolian who had married your
	mother,	
30	<i>nu-a-um : gám-ra-am a-na</i>	that Anatolian paid the
	<i>ki-ša-ar-ší-im : ig-mu-ur-/ma</i>	expenses made for (in) the jail and
	<i>iš-tù nu-a-um : ga-ma-ar-šu</i>	after the Anatolian had recovered his
	<i>il₅-qé-ú : lu a-na bi-ki-tim</i>	expenses, 27 shekels of silver have been
	<i>ša um-mi-ki ù a-he-ki (erasure)</i>	spent for the bewailing of your mother
35	<i>⅓ ma-na 7 GÍN KÙ.B. ga-me-er</i>	and your brothers. Here
	<i>a-na-kam : ša ki-ma DUMU Hi-na-a</i>	the representative of the son of
	<i>[D]AM.GÀR-ru-um ša a-he/í-ki</i>	Hinnāya, the creditor of your brother(s),
	<i>a-na ša-ba-at KÙ.B.</i>	took steps to seize the silver,
LE	<i>[i-z]i-iz-ma En-um-A-šūr ù</i>	but Ennam-Aššur and

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- 40 [Šu-mi-a-b]i-a ša ki-ma ku-a-ti Šumi-abiya, your representatives
 [x x x₂*-ma um-ma né-nu-ma KÙ.B [warned us] and we said:
 [lá i]-ša-ba-at : KÙ.B. : ma-nu-šu 'He shall not seize the silver!' Who is he
 (to try such a thing?)..."

Notes

2. See for Atāya, perhaps the son of Bušiya (*168:2), a friend or associate of Elamma in Assur, Introduction § 3.1 end. Puzur-Aššur, a man with an extremely frequent name, probably was the son of Ikūppiya, who figures in our file in *183:15, *185:1 and *187:1.

6-7 Collation shows that the tablet has indeed *a-hu-ki*, and not *a-hu-ú-a* (cancel the comments in Veenhof 2008, 108, on line 6) and that what I first read as **mu-mi-tim* actually is *mu-wa-tim*.

16, 27. *išû qātišu*, "property at hand", "cash". Also in AKT 6-b, 315:13, "guard every shekel you have available (KÙ.B. 1 GÍN *i-šu qātiki*); TC 3, 66:22, *i-šu bēt abikunu*; Prag I 440: 31, *ištu i-ši ú qātia agmuru*; and below *189:47, KÙ.B. 1 GÍN *i-šu qātika*. They show that *išûm* here is a noun, according to K. Hecker, *NABU* 1996/16, a misunderstood infinitive, in Prag I 440 with a possessive suffix.

21. The last sign, GA, must be a mistake for KI, since Šīmat-Ištar is main addressee.

24-26. Had the departure for the *sikkatum* anything to do with Iliya's imprisonment?

26. "We" are in the first place the writers of the letter (also Lamassutum?), but it may have been used in a wider sense, perhaps "our family", perhaps even "we Assyrians".

28-32. It is remarkable that Ištar-lamassī's second husband, Lullu, son of Hapi, mentioned by name in *187:5-6 and 17, is here, in *181:30 and in *184:16 simply referred to as "the native", "the Anatolian". Was it because the daughter (and other relatives in Assur), to whom the letters were sent, was not familiar with his name? Note also that *181:27-30 asks her "Have you not heard that your mother is since ten years married to an Anatolian and lives in his house?" Lullu occurs, together with two sons of Elamma, also in texts *170-172, where he plays a role in the arrangements necessary after the death of Elamma's son Aššur-ṭāb. In addition we meet him in the damaged memorandum Our Lullu might be identical to the witness of *309:13, a debt-note for grain owed by Hada[...].

41. The missing verb is a guess based on the context.

181. Kt 91/k 425 (1-277-91)

The continuation of a letter to Šīmat-Ištar (see lines 8-9 and 16), which starts by quoting what the writers had told the persons (presumably creditors) who threatened to take the silver Ištar-lamassī had left for her daughter. It then reports how this claim was refuted and gives details about the financial arrangement and what was sent to Assur. Finally it mentions the presence of un-opened containers with tablets of Ištar-lamassī and her sons and warns Šīmat-Ištar that, due to her mother's second marriage, she must not expect to receive much silver.

- KÙ.B. ša um-ma-ša : a-na me-er/i-ti-ša "The silver that her mother left to
i-ba-áb-tim : té-zi-bu her daughter as part of the outstanding
a-na hu-bu-ul : a-na claims, do you^{plur.} want to take it
a-he/i-ša : a-tù-nu : ta-lá-qé-a as debt, for her brother(s)?"
 5 *ni-zi-iz-ma* : i-na We took action and rebutted
a-wa-tim : ni-bu-šu-nu-ma them by our argumentation.

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	<i>iš-tù : gám-ru-um ù ša a-na</i>	After the expenses made for the
	<i>bi-ki-tim : ša um-mi-ki</i>	bewailing of your mother and
	<i>ù a-he-ki : iš-hi-ru : ší-tí</i>	your brothers had been deducted,
10	KÙ.B ½ <i>ma-na</i> 7 GÍN KÙ.B.	37 shekels of silver and 2¼
	<i>ù 2¼ GÍN KÙ.GI ku-nu-ki</i>	shekels of gold, under the seals
	<i>ša En-um-A-šūr ù</i>	of Ennam-Aššur and Šumi-abiya
	<i>Šu-mi-a-bi-a : a-na En-um-DINGIR</i>	we together entrusted to
l.e	DUMU <i>Ha-da-a : i-na</i>	Ennam-ilī, the son of Hadāya,
15	<i>pu-ùh-ri-ni : ni-ip-qí-/id-ma</i>	and he is on his way
rev.	<i>na-áš-a-ki-im</i>	to you with it.
	<i>i-na ŠĀ.BA KÙ.B. ri-ik-sí-/im</i>	In the packet of silver 2¼ shekels
	<i>2¼ GÍN KÙ.B. ša I-lí-a</i>	of silver of Iliya, excise
	<i>ni-is-ha-tum : ša A-šūr (eras.)</i>	for Aššur, had been put.
20	<i>na-ad-a : KÙ.B šu-a-tí a-na</i>	Give that silver to the office
	<i>É li-mi-im : dí-ni : KÙ.B</i>	of the <i>līmum</i> ; this silver
	<i>a-ni-um : É E-lá-ma : ib-ší</i>	was in Elamma's house.
	<i>2 ší-il₅-a-nu : ša tup-pé-e</i>	There are still two š.-containers with
	<i>ku-nu-ku : ša a-he-ki ù um-mi-/°ki₂</i>	tablets sealed by your brothers
25	<i>i-ba-ší-ú : pá-al-ha-[nī]-ma</i>	and mother. We did not dare to open
	<i>pá-ťá-ra-am ú-lá ni-mu-wa</i>	them because we were afraid.
	<i>lá ta-áš-ta-na-me-i : ki-ma</i>	Have you not heard that
u.e.	<i>um-mi-ki : iš-tù 10 ša-na-/tim</i>	the Anatolian is since ten years
	<i>nu-a-um ah-zu-ma</i>	married to your mother and that
le.e.	<i>i-na É nu-a-im wa-áš-ba-at-/ni</i>	she lived in the house of the
31	<i><a-na> KÙ.B. ma-dí-im : mi-ma</i>	Anatolian? Do by no means expect much
	<i>lá ta-da-gi₅-li : KÙ.B</i>	silver, (there are only) the
	before-mentioned	
	<i>a-mi-um ù KIŠIB-kam um-mi-ki</i>	silver and the seal your mother."

Notes

3-4. *Hu-bu-ul* in the absolute state is strange, perhaps something (a PN or an ending with pron. suffix) was omitted. What we read here is also mentioned *180:36-39, where "a creditor of your brother(s)" wants to seize money meant for Šimat-Ištar, but in our text the danger comes from more than one person (*talaqqe'ā*), but who they are is unknown.

6. See for the verb *bu'ā'um*, usually with a personal accusative suffix and with *ina awātim*, "by words, arguments", Veenhof *Lex*, s.v

7-9. The cost of the bewailing etc. had been advanced by Ištar-lamassī's second husband, the expenses are those for his jailed son-in-law (*gamrum ana kišaršim*, *180:30-31).

15. *ina puhri_{ni}*, "we jointly", cf. *CAD P*, 492, 2, also in *185:12, *ippuhrišunu*, TPAK 1, 4:18 and in Kt 88/k 963:28, *ippuhrikunu eršānim*. OA also uses the absolute state of the noun, *puhur*, as an adverb, see *CAD P* s.v. *puhur*, b.

17-21. Iliya must have been engaged in trade since the *nishatum* was levied in Assur upon the arrival of the caravan with silver and gold. *183:4-6 mentions that Iliya left this debt behind (when he died).

33. As stipulated in Ištar-lamassī's last will, *179:11. Not **kunuk ummiki*, therefore a verb has to be supplied.

182. Kt 91/k 438 (1-291-91)

A witnessed transport contract, recording that the silver and gold that Ištar-lamassī had left (as safe deposit) to Lamassutum, was entrusted by the latter, assisted by her eldest son, to two men known as representatives of Ištar-lamassī's children, for shipment to Assur, to Šīmat-Ištar.

	$\frac{1}{2}$ <i>ma-na</i> 7 GÍN KÙ.B.	37 shekels of silver
	ú $2\frac{1}{4}$ GÍN KÙ.GI <i>Ištar-lá-ma-/sī</i>	and $2\frac{1}{4}$ shekels of gold
	DAM <i>Ku-ni-li</i>	Ištar-lamassī, wife of Kūn-ilum,
	<i>a-na Lá-ma-sà-tim</i>	left to Lamassutum,
5	DAM <i>E-lá-ma</i>	wife of Elamma.
	<i>té-zi-ib</i> KÙ.B ú KÙ.KI	That silver and gold
	<i>a-na En-nam-A-šur</i>	Lamassutum, wife of
	DUMU <i>A-šur-dan</i>	Elamma, attended by
l.e.	ú <i>Šu-<mi>-a-bi₄-a</i> DUMU <i>A-mu-a</i>	Elamma's son Ennam-Aššur,
rev.	<i>Lá-ma-sà-tum</i>	entrusted to Ennam-Aššur,
11	DAM <i>E-lá-ma</i> (erasure)	son of Aššur-dān, and
	ú <i>En-nam-A-šur</i> DUMU	Šumi-abiya,
	<i>E-lá-ma i-ša-ha-at</i>	son of Amua.
	<i>um-mi-šu i-zi-iz-ma</i>	In the presence of
15	<i>ip-qí-du</i> IGI <i>Puzur₂-A-šur</i>	Puzur-Aššur,
	DUMU <i>I-ku-pí-a</i> IGI <i>A-mur-DINGIR</i>	son of Ikuppiya,
	DUMU <i>Šu-Ku-bi-im</i>	of Amur-ilī, son of Šu-Kūbum,
	IGI <i>Ma-ši-i-lí</i>	of Maši-ilī, son
u.e.	DUMU <i>Bu-zu-zu</i>	of Buzuzu,
le.e	IGI <i>Puzur₂-Ištar</i>	of Puzur-Ištar,
21	DUMU <i>Šu-Ku-bi-im</i>	son of Šu-Kūbum.

Notes

9. See also *183:13, where the name of Šumi-abiya's father is spelled *E-mu-a*. The same variation in Kt 93/k 449:3 (*A-mu-a*) and 361:3 (*E-mu-a*), in both cases the father of Aššur-ṭāb (courtesy of C. Michel).

15. From *181:12-15 and *183:11-20-15 we know that the men to whom it was entrusted in turn gave it to a transporter, Ennum-ilī. *181:15 also mentions that this was a joint action (*ina puhriṇi*) by those involved in the affair.

183. Kt 91/k 413 (1-266-91)

A witnessed transport contract, comparable to *180, stating that the silver and gold already mentioned there (increased by $2\frac{1}{4}$ shekels of silver due as excise by Iliya), given in deposit (*ana nabšēm*) to Lamassutum by Ištar-lamassī, apparently after the death of her sons were put under seal by the representatives of the latter and entrusted to a transporter (as already known from *179:13-15) to bring it to Assur, to Šīmat-Ištar.

$1/2$ <i>ma-na</i> LÁ 1 GÍN KÙ.B.	29 shekels of silver,
<i>a-ha-ma</i> 8 GÍN KÙ.B.	separately 8 shekels of silver and

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	ù 2¼ GÍN KÙ.KI ša DAM Ku-ni-lim	2¼ shekels of gold of Kūn-ilum's wife,
	2¼ GÍN KÙ.B. ni-is-ha-tum	2¼ shekels of silver, excise
5	ša A-šur I-li-a DUMU Ku-ni-lim	for Assur, Iliya, son of Kūn-ilum
	e-zi-ib KÙ.B. a-ni-um	left behind. This money,
	ša Ištar-lá-ma-sí DAM	which Ištar-lamassī, Kūn-ilum's
	Ku-ni-lim a-na na-áb-šé-em	wife, had given in deposit
	a-na Lá-ma-sà-tim	to Lamassutum,
10	DAM E-lá-ma ta-dí-nu	Elamma's wife -
l.e.	ki-ma me-er-e Ku-ni-lim	acting for Kūn-ilum's sons
rev.	En-um-A-šur DUMU A-šur-dan	Ennam-Aššur, son of Aššur-dān,
	ù Šu-mí-a-bi ₄ -a DUMU E-mu-a	and Šumi-abiya, son of Emua,
	ša-zu-uz-tum ša	the representative of
15	me-er-e Ku-ni-lim KÙ.B. ù	Kūn-ilum's sons, have sealed
	KÙ.KI ik-nu-ku-ma a-na	this silver and gold and
	En-um-i-lí DUMU Ha-da-/a	we entrusted it to Ennam-ilī,
	ni-ip-qí-<id>-ma : a-na a-lim ^{ki}	son of Hadāya, to bring it to the
	a-šé-er DUMU.MÍ Ku-ni-lim	City, to the address of Kūn-ilum's
20	ú-ba-al : ša-du-a-sú	daughter. He has been paid his
	ša-bu IGI Ip-pa-lu	transport fee. In the presence of
	DUMU A-mur-Ištar	Ippalu, son of Amur-Ištar,
u.e.	IGI A-šur-ma-lik DUMU A-mu-ra	of Aššur-mālik, son of Amura,
	IGI A-šur-i-mi-tí DUMU A-ni-nim	of Aššur-imittī, son of Anīnum.

Notes

4-6. This is an older debt, owed by Iliya to the "līmum office" in Assur, as *179:17-21 states (adding that this silver was put inside a larger packet). In l. 6 I translate "money", because KÙ.B. refers to silver and gold together.

7-9. The deduction of expenses and the costs of the bewailing are what Ištar-lamassī's second husband had advanced; the expenses are those for his jailed son-in-law (*gamrum ana kišaršim*, *178:30-31). These lines mention usual expenses connected with transport to Assur, the excise to be paid there (and thus added to the shipment) and the transport fee, due to the transporter.

13. See the note on *182:9.

184. Kt 91/k 441 (1-293-91)

A small, oblong memorandum explaining that all that remains of the silver Ištar-lamassī had given to her sons, after deducting what Iliya had already taken, a debt owed by him, and the funerary expenses for him, his brother and his mother, will go to Šīmat-Ištar in Assur.

	i-na KÙ.B.-áp Ištar-lá-ma-/sí	From the silver of Ištar-lamassī
	ša : a : DUMU-e-ša	that she gave to her sons
	ta-dí-nu-ma KÙ.B. i-na'	and which silver rested as safe deposit
	É ¹ E-lá-ma a-na-áb-šé-em	in Elamma's house,
5	ib-ší-ú ŠĀ.BA 7 GÍN	from that silver Iliya, when he was
	KÙ.B. I-lí-a i-bu-ul-tí-šu	still alive, took 7 shekels from
	i-qá-tí-šu il ₅ -qé iš-tù	his share. After the sons of
	DUMU-ú Ku-ni-lim me-tù	Kūn-ilum had died,

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l.e. <i>lu a-na bi-ki-tí-šu-nu</i>	(when) our brothers arrived for
10 <i>lu a-ku-sí-im ša</i>	bewailing them and
rev. <i>um-mì-šu-nu tá-bu-im</i>	for removing the chair
<i>a-hu-ni e-ru-bu-ni-ma</i>	of their mother,
$\frac{1}{3}$ <i>ma-na</i> LĀ $\frac{1}{2}$ GÍN KÙ.B.	19½ shekels of silver
<i>lu a-bi₄-ki-tí-šu-nu lu a-na</i>	were paid both for bewailing them
15 <i>ku-sí-im ša um-mì-šu-nu</i>	and for the chair of their mother,
<i>lu a-na nu-a-im a-šu-mi l-lí-a</i>	and also to the Anatolian, because of
$7\frac{1}{2}$ GÍN KÙ/B.	līya, 7½ shekels of silver
<i>a-hu-bu--šu i-ší-qí-il₅</i>	for his debt.
<i>ší-tí KÙ.B. a-še-er</i>	The rest of the silver was sent to address
20 <i>a-ha-tí-šu-nu DUMU.MÍ Ku-ni-lim</i>	of their sister, the daughter of Kūn-ilum,
l.e. <i>a-na a-lim^{ki} : DUMU A-šur-dan</i>	to the City, by son of Aššur-dān
<i>ù Šu-ma-bi-a ša ki-ma</i>	and Šumi-abiya, the representatives
<i>DUMU-e Ku-ni-lim ú-še-bi₄-lu</i>	of Kūn-ilum's sons.

Notes

2, 7. Note the “word dividers” between the assimilated *a(na)* and the noun.

3-4. The last sign of 3 is not a good NA, perhaps an imperfect É, repeated at the beginning of l. 4, where É is also not well drawn and looks like KÙ. While depositing silver among (*ina*) goods of somebody else seems possible, depositing it in a house is more likely and *181:22 mentions that it was in Elamma's house.

10-11. My transliteration in Veenhof 2008a, 113, by mistake repeats line 10. The “removal of the chair” of a person who had died has now also turned up in a short text from the first archive excavated in 1994 (courtesy of G. Barjamovic; see AKT 6-a, 3 note 1), Kt 94/k 554, which records the expenses of this ceremony, presumably ingredients for a meal: *1 naruq 2 DUG GIG / 1 naruq 2 DUG / buqlim / ana ku-sí-im* (5) *ša ummiša / tá-bu-im / Anana / DAM Ēnah-ilī / ana Šalimma* (10) *tahbul*, “For 1 sack and 2 jars of wheat (and) 1 sack and 2 jars of malt, for the removal of the chair of her mother, Anana, the wife of Ēnah-ilī, became indebted to Šalimma”. Šalimma apparently had advanced these items to the married daughter of a deceased woman.

12. “Our brothers” must be the relatives who took care of the funerary ceremonies.

185. Kt 91/k 446 (1-298-91)

A memorandum recording that eight persons collectively (*ippuhrišunu*) paid the expenses for the bewailing of Ištar-lamassī and her sons and for the chair of Ištar-lamassī, drawing on the silver the latter had in deposit in Elamma's house. Ennam-Aššur and Šumi-abiya had sealed the container with relevant records (for shipment to Assur?).

<i>Puzur₄-A-šur DUMU l-ku-/pí-a</i>	Puzur-Aššur, son of Ikuppia
<i>En-um-A-šur DUMU l-dí-/Sú-/in</i>	Ennam-Aššur, son of Iddin-Suen,
<i>ù a-hu-šu</i>	and his brother,
<i>l-dí-Ištar DUMU Ah-ša-lim</i>	Iddin-Ištar, son of Ah-šalim,
5 <i>Ištar-ba-ni</i>	Ištar-bāni,
<i>Ma-ší-i-lí</i>	Maši-ilī

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<i>En-nam-A-šur</i>	Ennam-Aššur,
DUMU A-šur-dan	son of Aššur-dān,
l.e. <i>Šu-ma-a-bi₄-a</i>	Šumi-abiya -
10 <i>ša ki-ma</i>	representing
DUMU-e <i>Ku-ni-lim</i>	the sons of Kūn-ilum -
<i>i-pu-ùh-ri-šu-nu <gamram ša></i>	collectively paid <the expenses>
<i>bi₄-ki-tí-šu-nu</i>	of bewailing them and
<i>ù ku-sí-im ša Ištar/-lá-/ma-sí</i>	of Ištar-lamassī's chair
15 <i>i-KÙ.B. ša i-É</i>	from the silver that was
u.e. DAM <i>E-lá-ma ib-ší-ú</i>	was in the house of
<i>ig-mu-ru</i>	Elamma's wife.
l.e. <i>hu-ša-li DUMU A-šur-l dan</i>	The son of Aššur-dān
<i>ù Šu-ma-a-bi₄-a</i>	and Šumi-abiya
20 <i>ik-nu-ku</i>	sealed the pouches.

Notes

1-8. Several of the persons listed here occur in other records of the file:

Ennum-Aššur, son of Iddin-Suen, perhaps witness to Ištar-lamassī's testament (*179:29); also witness to the testamentary agreement *297:2-3;

Ennam-Aššur, son of Aššur-dān, also in *180:39 and *183:12, represents Ištar-lamassī's sons;

Iddin-Ištar, son of Ah-šalim, only here with his father's name, but perhaps in *105:24 (mentioned alongside Kūn-ilum);

Ištar-bāni, perhaps the son of Asqūdum, mentioned in *306:1, 5;

Maši-ilī, the son of Buzuzu, cf. *182:18-19, witness to Ištar-lamassī's testament in *179:28;

Puzur-Aššur, son of Ikūppiya, figures as witness in *185:1 and *187:1, might be the writer (together with Lamassutum) of the letter *180;

Šumi-abiya, son of A/Emu'a, the well-known representative (*ša kīma* and in *183:14 designated as "legal representative", *šazzuztum*) of the sons of Ištar-lamassī.

13-14. The genitives *bikītišunu* and *kussim* are difficult and I assume that before them *gamram ša* has been omitted; cf. *gamram ša gamārum* in *179:30-31 and *187:10-11.

18. *Hušālum* is the name for a kind of bag or pouch used for storing or transporting tablets, cf. AKT 3, 82:4, *ina hušālim / ina libbi ṭuppē / tahsistum patītum/nad'at*, "in the *hušālum* an unsealed memo is placed among the tablets". The son of Aššur-dān must be Ennam-Aššur, cf. *183:12, where he represents the sons of Kūn-ilum together with Šumi-abiya.

186. Kt 91/k 348 (1-205-91)

A witnessed record of a confrontation between two persons, in which the one speaking states that he had entrusted to the other various items to satisfy Lullu for his claim on Ilabrat-bāni and that the other owes him what after that remains of the silver into which these assets were converted.

1 1 *ṭup-pá-am ša Bi-zi-lá*

(Of) 1 tablet of Bizila

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	<i>ù Ištar-lá-ma-sí : qá-sá</i>	and Ištar-lamassī, the share
	<i>ša Ištar-lá-ma-sí</i>	of Ištar-lamassī;
	<i>2 qá-áb-li-a-tim</i>	2 <i>qablītu</i> -containers
5	<i>ša 1 ma-na.TA KÙ.B.</i>	of 1 mina silver each ,
	<i>iš-té-et a-hu-úz-tum</i>	one with inlay;
	<i>mu-ša-lá-am ša ZABAR</i>	a bronze mirror
	<i>ù ma-az-li-ki</i>	and some <i>mazliku</i> .
	<i>mì-ma : a-nim : a-na</i>	All this I entrusted to
10	<i>hu-bu-ul ^dNIN.ŠUBUR-ba-ni</i>	Lullu for the debt
	<i>a-na Lu-lu (áp-qí-id erased)</i>	of Ilabrat-bāni,
l.e.	<i>áp-qí-id um-ma a-na-ku-ma</i>	with the words:
	<i>a-na É a-bi-a ù</i>	"You shall not again claim
rev.	<i>um-mì-a a-na mì-ma</i>	anything from the house of
15	<i>šu-um-šu ú-lá ta-tù-/ar</i>	my father and mother,
	<i>lu i-na ší-im bé-tim</i>	neither from the price of the house,
	<i>lu i-ši-im TÚG.HI.A</i>	nor from the price of textiles,
	<i>lu i-ši-im qá-áb-li-a-/tim</i>	nor from the price of <i>qablītu</i> 's,
	<i>mu-ša-li-im</i>	the mirror,
20	<i>ù ma-az-li-ki</i>	and the <i>mazliku</i> 's.
	<i>iš-^otù₂ : nu-a-am : hu-bu-ul</i>	After you will have paid
	<i>^dNIN.ŠUBUR-ba-ni</i>	the Anatolian the debt of
	<i>tù-ša-bu-ú : ší-tum</i>	Ilabrat-bāni, for the rest
	<i>KÙ.B. : mì-ma i-na li-bi-kà</i>	of the silver, whatever you
25	<i>i-ši-tù : i-le-e</i>	still owe me I have the gods
	<i>i-na li-bi-kà i-šu-ú</i>	as claim on you.
	<i>i-na tup-pí-im : pá-qá-dim</i>	When the tablet was handed over
u.e	<i>Bi-za-lá : a-na qá-tí-ša</i>	Bizala took responsibility for
	<i>ta-zi-iz : IGI Dan-A-šur</i>	her share. In the presence of Dān-Aššur,
le.e.	<i>IGI A-mur-DINGIR IGI Ma-ší-i-lí</i>	of Amur-ili, of Maši-ilī,
31	<i>IGI A-šur-iš-ta-ki-il₅</i>	of Aššuriš-takil.
	<i>IGI Ha-pu-a-šu ša SÍG.HI.A</i>	of Happuaša, the wool-trader,
	<i>IGI Puzur₂-Ištar</i>	and of Puzur-Ištar.

Notes

The scribe writes the sign ŠA with only a minimal indication of the final vertical wedge.

6. See for *qablītum a-hu-úz-tum*, TC 3, 107:25 *kaspum ana qabliāti[m] a¹-hu-zi-im*, and KTK 19:27f. *qablītam ú-hu-úz-tam*, forms which illustrate the variation in the quality of the first vowel in the D-stem of l' verbs of the a-class (*uhhuztum* not registered in *GKT* § 89b, where the statement "in den präfigierten Formen immer *u*, sonst *a*" has to be corrected).

25-26. The same expression also in AKT 5, 40:27-28 and 51:25-26. My original interpretation, that the valuable statuettes of the (family) gods served as pledge, is rather unlikely, as Kouwenberg pointed out. The literal translation given here follows *Grammar* § 14.60 end; see Veenhof *Lex.*, s.v.

33. The Anatolian Happuašu probably served as witness, because Bizila was an Anatolian woman. See for his profession, *KEL* 25.

Comment

Neither the speaker (l. 12, "I entrusted", etc.), nor the one addressed (l. 15, "you shall not claim", l. 25, "I have a claim on you") in this record are identified and the text is not

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dated. The speaker “entrusted” to the person addressed property – Ištar-lamassī’s share in an asset owned jointly with a certain Bizila¹ and various precious objects of silver and bronze - for paying what her son Ilabrat-bāni owed to Lullu. He then states that whatever silver remains after “you have satisfied the Anatolian” (i.e. Lullu, lines 21-23) counts as a debt owed by him to the speaker. The words “the house of my father and my mother” (lines 13-14) and the fact that the main concern is the debt of Ilabrat-bāni, suggests that the speaker was Iliya, the eldest son of Ištar-lamassī (which implies that “the house of my father” is what was left by Ištar-lamassī’s first, Assyrian husband, which her children would inherit). If so, the text must be dated before her sons had died. That the property was “entrusted” (*paqādum*, l. 12) means that the recipient had to use it for the purpose stated and lines 21-26 assume that not all silver was needed, so that the speaker maintains a claim on the recipient, described as “for *i-le-e*”. This probably means “(statuettes of) gods”, however surprising that may be, but see for these statuettes the comment on AKT 5, 35:5. The addressee is explicitly denied any claim on other assets of Ištar-lamassī or the family, described as “the price” of a house, textiles and precious objects, which means that these items were or would be sold, which suggests that Ištar-lamassī’s household was liquidated.

187. Kt 91/k 394 (1-248-91)

A sealed, unopened envelope containing a quittance, stating that Lullu <has been paid> the expenses he made for his (dead) wife (“the lady”) and her son Iliya and will not claim anything from the sons of Hanum.

	KIŠIB <i>Puzur₄-A-šur</i> DUMU <i>I-ku-pí-a</i> seal A	Seal of Puzur-Aššur, son of Ikuppiya,
	KIŠIB <i>Dan-A-šur</i> DUMU <i>Puzur₄-A-šur</i>	seal of Dān-Aššur, son of Puzur-Aššur,
	KIŠIB <i>Pè-ru-a</i> DUMU <i>Šu-up-ip-ra</i>	seal of Peruwa, son of Šuppibra,
	KIŠIB <i>Pè-ru-a</i> DUMU <i>A-ra-wa</i>	seal of Peruwa, son of Arawa,
5	KIŠIB <i>Za-ba</i> DUMU <i>Ha-nu</i> KIŠIB <i>Lu-lu</i> seal B	seal of Zaba, son of Hanu, seal of Lullu,
i.e.	DUMU <i>Ha-pí Lu-lu</i> DUMU <i>Ha-pí</i> seal A (upside down)	son of Hapi. Lullu, son of Hapi,
rev.	<i>ša Ištar-lá-ma-sí</i> DAM <i>Ku-ni-lim</i> seal C	who had married Ištar-lamassī, wife of
	<i>e-hu-zu iš-tù a-wi-il₅-tum</i>	Kūn-ilum. After the lady
	<i>me-ta-at-ni a-wa-tù-šu-nu</i>	had died, their affairs were
10	<i>i-gi₅-im-ra-ma lu gám-ra-am</i>	were settled. As for the expenses
	<i>ša a-na a-wi-il₅-tim ig-mu-ru</i>	made for the lady,
	<i>lu a-na I-lí-a ša a-na</i>	and those made for Iliya, who

¹ The assets enumerated in lines 16-20, to be used for satisfying Lullu, must be the same as those of lines 1-8, entrusted for the same purpose. This may imply the “the price of the house and the price of the textiles” specify what it meant by “the tablet” of line 1. Lines 27-29 state that when the tablet (the one of lines 1-3) was entrusted to the addressee, “Bizila took responsibility for her share”, which must mean that she made sure that when the claim it embodied was converted into silver she would receive her share. We do not know who Bizila was, wild guesses are that she could be a daughter born from the marriage of Lullu and Ištar-lamassī or Lullu’s daughter who had been married by the now dead Iliya.

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	seal A (upside down)	
	<< a >> <i>ki-šar'-šī-im i-ni-id-ú</i>	had been thrown into jail,
	(erasure) <i>Lu-lu gám-ra-am</i>	expenses that Lullu had paid,
u.e	seal D	
15	<i>ig-mu-ru lu ša a-wi-il₅-tim</i>	for both those for the lady,
le.e.	<i>lu a-ša Ì-lí-a a-na mi-ma šu-um-/šu</i>	and those for Iliya, Lullu, son
	(seal D) <i>a-na me-er-e</i>	of Hapi, will not raise claims
	<i>Ha-ni-im Lu-lu DUMU Ha-pi lá i-tù-/ar</i>	against the sons of Hanum.
r.e.	seal E	

Seals

A = CS 259, found on various tablets (see N. Özgüç 2006, pl. 2; also as Kt f/k 184A), the seal of Peruwa, son of Šuppibra.

B = CS 1166

C = CS 1167

D = CS 1168

E = CS 106 = Kt n/k 1728A (eight times, on the envelope of a letter; see N. Özgüç 2006, 113 for additional impressions). Our text confirms the conclusion of A. Karaduman that it is the seal of Dān-Aššur, son of Puzur-Aššur.

The envelope lists six sealers, but there are only five different seal impressions. It seems likely that the two Anatolian witnesses of lines 4-5 are represented by one single seal impression. One would like to know which seal Lullu used.

Notes

1. Dated occurrences of Puzur-Aššur, son of Ikūn-pī-Ištar/Ikūppiya (also in *185:1) are in epo-nymy years REL 96-100: ICK 2, 125:18, Kt k/k 44:2 and Kt 91/k 198:5.

4. A Peruwa, son of Arara, is the first sealer of Kt d/k 51A (but l. 14 of the tablet mentions Arara as witness), but none of the seals on this envelope is identical to one on our text.

13-14. Cf. *180:25-31, where we learn that Lullu paid Iliya's "expenses for the jail" (his maintenance, or perhaps a ransom to get him free), no doubt because Iliya was his stepson and married to his daughter. At the beginning of 14 *i-ni-id-ú* was repeated and then erased.

15-16. Note the distinction between expenses *ša awīltim* and *a-ša Iliya*, although lines 11f. speak in both cases of expenses *ana*.

16-17. Lullu has to promise that he will not claim anything from "the sons of Hanum", apparently because during the successful proceedings (lines 9-10, *awātušunu iggimrā*) they had been satisfied. We do not know what claim he had on them, nor who they were. If Hanum is the same as Hanu in line 5, his son Zaba may have sealed not as witness, but as party (acting for his brother?).

Comment

This sealed legal document, in which Lullu renounces any further claims, was kept in Kanesh where he lived and might decide to claim more. We do not know who "the sons of Hanum" are, against whom Lullu, now that his expenses are paid, "will not raise a claim on anything belonging to the lady (Ištar-lamassī) or to Iliya". Had "the sons of Hanum" perhaps acquired the house of the dead family?

188. Kt 91/k 369 (1-226-91)

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A memorandum in the first person plural on payments made for or at the time of the bewailing (*bikītum*), mostly for food and drinks, amounting to in all 15 5/12 shekels, which were paid from the 20 shekels of silver that are Ilabrat-bāni's share in his mother's inheritance.

	<i>i-na 1/3 ma-na KÙ.B.</i>	From the 1/3 mina of silver
	<i>ša qá-tí °NIN.ŠUBUR-ba-/ni</i>	that was Ilabrat-bāni's share
	<i>2 GÍN a-na bi₄-ki-tim</i>	we booked 2 shekels for
	<i>ni-il₅-pu-tù 2 2/3 GÍN</i>	the bewailing; 2 2/3 shekels
5	<i>KÙ.B. a-na GIG a-Lu-lu</i>	silver for wheat we gave
	<i>ni-dí-in 2 ki-ra-tim</i>	to Lullu, 2 jars of beer we
	<i>i-ša-am-ší bi₄-ki-tim ni-il₅-/qé</i>	took on the day of the bewailing;
	<i>i-na ša(°NI)-nim u₄-mì-im</i>	on the second day we paid
	<i>3 1/4 GÍN a-2 UDU.HI.A</i>	3 1/4 shekels for 2 sheep;
10	<i>ni-iš-qúl 1/3 GÍN 7 1/2 ŠE</i>	3/8 shekel
l.e.	<i>a-na e-šé 1/4 GÍN</i>	for firewood; 1/4 shekel
	<i>a-sú-ba-ri-im</i>	for <i>subārum</i> ;
rev.	<i>1/4 GÍN a-na qá-nu-e</i>	1/4 shekel for reed;
	<i>15 ŠE a-šu-um-ke 15 ŠE</i>	1/12 shekel for onions, 1/12
15	<i>a-qá-nu-e ša ki-ra-tim</i>	shekel for reed for the jars;
	<i>2 1/6 GÍN a-na UDU e-ri-/im</i>	2 1/6 shekels for a 'naked' sheep;
	<i>7 ki-ra-tim 1/3 GÍN 7 1/2 ŠE</i>	7 jars of beer we drew, 3/8 shekel;
	<i>ni-is-bi₄ : i-na ša-nim u₄-mì-im</i>	on the second day
	<i>4 ki-ra-tim ni-is-bi₄</i>	4 jars of beer we drew;
20	<i>1 GÍN KÙ.B. DUMU A-šur-dan ù</i>	1 shekel of silver (for) the son of Aššur-dān
	<i>1 1/3 GÍN a-na Lu-lu a-na GIG</i>	and 1 1/3 shekel for Lullu, for wheat,
u.e.	<i>nu-ra-dí 1/2 GÍN 15 <ŠE> a-na</i>	we added; 7/12 shekels for
	<i>2 ki-ra-tim ni-iš-qúl</i>	2 jars of beer we paid;
	<i>1 GÍN KÙ.B. a-na UDU ni-iš-qúl</i>	1 shekel silver we paid for a sheep.

Notes

5, 21. The wheat for which Lullu was paid was presumably used for a meal.

6-8. No price is mentioned; lines 22-23 may have been added to supply the information.

8. Cf. line 18; the ceremony seems to have taken two days.

11. The firewood must have served to cook the meat of the in all four sheep.

12. *subārum* is an unidentified foodstuff, which occurs more often in such enumerations.

16. "Pregnant" is unlikely. Kouwenberg suggests *erium*, "naked, empty" = recently shorn?

20. Aššur-dān's son most probably is Ennam-Aššur (see *182:7-8), who represented the sons of Ištar-lamassī and Kūn-ilum.

General comment

While what happened after the death of Ištar-lamassī and both her sons is in the main clear, problems of interpretation remain. The identity and role of most of the persons involved in the affair is understood, especially of those protecting the interests of Ištar-lamassī and her children, also the writers of most of our records. They are relatives, Lamassutum and her son Ennam-Aššur, representatives of Ištar-lamassī's

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children, Ennum-Aššur, son of Aššur-dan and Šumi-abiya, son of A/Emua, and probably also those who witnessed Ištar-lamassī's last will and may have been its executors (*bēl šimātim*), and perhaps also a few more people. They probably are the ones designated as "our brothers" (184*:12), who entered the house for the funerary rites and they must belong to the group to which *181:15 and *185:12 refer, mentioning actions *ina puhrini / ippuhrišunu*, "of us/them jointly". Those trying to get at the money Ištar-lamassī left behind, apart from Lullu, are elusive, "the son of Hinnāya, creditor of your brothers", who tried "to seize" it (*180:36-37), and anonymous persons who wished "to take it for the debt of her (Šimat-Ištar's) brothers". We also do not know who "the sons of Hanum" are, protected by *187:16-17 against any further claims of Lullu.

Uncertainties are also due to the nature of the texts. Some are clear, such as the (unfortunately damaged) testament *179 and the two transport contracts *182-183, which have legal force. They were written in view of the shipment of the money that remained to Assur; the first records that it was handed over to the two representatives of the children, the second how these men sealed it and entrusted it to a transporter. Text *186, a witnessed protocol about the use of the assets of Ištar-lamassī, whose speaker and addressee remain unidentified, has legal force, as does *187, an unopened sealed envelope that contains a witnessed record establishing that Lullu has been indemnified for all expenses paid for his dead wife ("the lady") and for Iliya (when he was in jail) and renounces (he has sealed the envelope) all further claims on the sons of Hanum. Text *180 is a letter sent to Assur, which ends fairly abruptly, and *181 apparently is the continuation of a letter, but not of *180, because it starts by quoting what the writers ("we") had told persons who wished to take what Ištar-lamassī had bequeathed to her daughter. The latter is the main addressee of both, as is clear from *180:5ff. and *181:8. Found in Elamma's archive they must be archive copies or perhaps drafts that remained in Kanesh. Text *184 is a memo written by the same "we" (l. 12); it mentions what was taken or paid (the main item are the costs of the funerary ceremonies; the verb is an impersonal passive, "it was paid") from what Ištar-lamassī had left to her sons and ends with the statement that what remained of it "will go to their sister" in Assur, of which the two representatives of the sons will take care. Text *185 is an memo recording that eight persons, including the two representatives, made (and paid) the expenses for the funerary rites "from the silver that was in the house of Elamma's wife" and that the representatives had sealed the containers (*hušālū*), apparently holding the relevant tablets (for shipment to Assur, together with the silver for Šimat-Ištar, or for safekeeping in the archive?). One of these tablets might have been *186, a memo whose writers ("we") specify how much silver was paid from what Ilabrat-bāni had inherited for the (presumably his) funerary ceremony (bemoaning, meals and drinks on two days); after deduction only 4 7/12 shekels remained of his share in the cash.

The sequence of the events and some texts raises problems. We do not know when Ištar-lamassī made her testament, but apparently there was time for her son Iliya "when he was still alive", as mentioned in *180:5-7, to "take 7 shekels of silver from his share", after his mother had "given" it to her children and when the money had already been deposited in Elamma's house. This letter explains that, after opening her sealed "coffer" (*tamalakkum*) Ištar-lamassī "gave" her children their shares in her cash money on her deathbed, in the presence of the "we" and three affiliated traders (*mer'ū ummiānī*, perhaps the witnesses to the testament). From lines 10-11 ("we entered with your mother") we get the impression that she was lying ill in her own house, where also her coffer was, and it seems likely that it was afterwards transferred to Elamma's house

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(did Iliya take a part of his share before or after this?). The agreement between the division of the cash money as reported in *180 and mentioned in the testament *177 could mean that she implemented her existing last will on her deathbed, but it is also possible that she decided on the division of her cash money then and there, so that the written testament was the result of the formal gathering at her deathbed, when “she spoke her word” (**awassa taqbi*). This expression is used twice for making one’s testamentary dispositions (in which the testator normally speaks in the first person singular) and in AKT 6a-44 is such an oral declaration in the presence of witnesses (see Veenhof 2012a, 170f.). The subsequent transfer of her money coffer to Elamma’s house (where also her last will was found) may have been a safety measure, perhaps because she was not certain about what her second Anatolian husband would do.

The division of Ištār-lamassī’s cash money is clear from her last will (*179): of the 57 shekels of silver available (in her coffer, *180:12) Iliya received 37 shekels, Ilabrat-bāni 20 and her daughter $7\frac{1}{2}$ shekels plus $2\frac{1}{4}$ shekels of gold (equal to ca. 20 shekels of silver) and also her mother’s seal. The same figures are found in *180:18-23, but here her daughter gets 8 shekels of silver. What was eventually sent to Assur to Šīmat-Ištār are $2\frac{1}{4}$ shekels of gold and 37 shekels of silver (*181:10-11, *182:1-2) and this last sum consists, as *183:1-2 shows, of the 8 shekels assigned to her by testament plus 29 shekels. This last amount is presumably what remained from her brothers’ shares after deduction of expenses for the “bemoaning” and for paying a debt owed by Iliya to Lullu. Text *180:35 mentions that these together amounted to 27 shekels and *184:16-18 that they included the $7\frac{1}{2}$ shekels paid for Iliya’s debt, so that the “bemoaning” of the mother and her two sons cost $19\frac{1}{2}$ shekels, indeed the figure given in *184:13. After deduction of these $19\frac{1}{2}$ shekels from the total of 57 shekels available according to the last will, there remained $37\frac{1}{2}$ shekels for Šīmat-Ištār, which is very close to what *181:10-11 and *182:1-2 state and identical if we assume with the last will that not 8 but $7\frac{1}{2}$ shekels were originally assigned to her.

It is not clear how the expenses for the bemoaning of Ilabrat-bāni and the accompanying funerary meals, recorded in *188 and amounting to $15\frac{5}{12}$ shekels of silver, fit into this picture. Are they included in the $19\frac{1}{2}$ shekels of *184:13 and do we have to assume similar expenses for Ištār-lamassī’s and Iliya’s funeral or was there one funerary ceremony and meal for all three? The question is also what we understand by *bikītum*, “bemoaning”. Was it exactly what the word means, which may have implied the hiring and perhaps feeding of wailing women, or a more general term for the whole funerary ceremony? *181:7-9 speaks of expenses (only) “for the “bemoaning of your mother and your brothers”, but *184:9-11 mentions “the bemoaning of them and the removal of the chair of their mother”, a combination also used when *185:13-14 mentions the expenses made for it. Memo *188 not only makes a distinction between expenses for “bemoaning” (l. 3) and those for food and drinks “on the day of the bemoaning” (l. 7), but states that the latter are paid cash (lines 10, 23-24), while those for the bemoaning are “booked” (*lapātum*), apparently to be accounted for later.

What Ištār-lamassī and presumably her sons left behind was more than cash money. Lines *179:13ff. of the last will mention “tablets”, presumably recording debts for which houses were held as pledge, and various metal objects which a woman (presumably Šīmat-Ištār) and Ištār-lamassī’s two sons would get. In *186:1-3 we read about a share (an asset recorded) in a tablet and various valuable objects (a few of which are also mentioned in *179: 23-26), all of which were entrusted to somebody for paying the debt owed by Ilabrat-bāni to Lullu. We do not know the origin of these

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assets, they might reflect Ištar-lamassī's own commercial activities, but also be what she had inherited (long ago) from her first Assyrian husband, who was engaged in trade, as we know from Elamma's archive (cf. *81:30-31, *121:5-6), property which she must have kept for herself after her second marriage. *181:23-26 mention that also two sealed containers (*šiliānū*) with tablets were deposited in Elamma's house. They may have contained the tablets mentioned in the last will (*179:17), the tablet mentioned in the memo *186:1-2, 23, and records that document the ownership of the house and textiles mentioned there in lines 16-17. The "silver from outstanding claims" (*bābtum*) left behind by Ištar-lamassī, mentioned in *181:2, must also have consisted of debt-notes and other records of claims (perhaps the tablets of *185:17), which the heirs could collect. Finally *186:16-20 mention "the price" of a house,² of textiles and of various precious objects, part of which would be used for paying the debt of Ilabrat-bāni.

It is important to distinguish between what the sons and what Šīmat-Ištar had inherited and what was used to pay the expenses. *181:4 reproaches anonymous persons, presumably creditors (cf. *180:36-37), of trying to take what was bequeathed to Šīmat-Ištar "for the debt of her brother(s)" (*a-HI-ša* can also render *ahhēša*, plur.), but their attempt was frustrated. Memo *188 indicates that Ilabrat-bāni's funeral was paid from his share (*qātum*) in the cash money as mentioned in the testament (*179:8-9) and his debt to Lullu would be paid by using assets of Ištar-lamassī (*186). The situation of Iliya, the eldest son, is more complex. He had been assigned more cash than his brother, 37 shekels of silver, but had already appropriated 7 shekels of it (*184:5-7). Moreover, he owed his father-in-law Lullu (*180:27-29) "the expenses for the jail" (*gamrum ana kišaršim*) the latter had paid for him after Iliya had spent all he had, a debt that amounted to 7 ½ shekels according to *184:17. How much he acquired as heir (apart from his own earnings, for he was involved in the trade, as the *nishatu*-debt owed to the *līmum*-office, mentioned in *181:18-21, shows) and what he owned at the time of his death is not clear. He had not only obtained some cash silver, but also the debt-notes mentioned in *179:17 and one *qablītu*-bowl (lines 23-25), and he may have been entitled to a share of Ištar-lamassī's assets when they were sold (*186:16:29). His sudden death leaves these questions – at least for us – unanswered and we know nothing about the commercial activities of him and his brother. But their and their mother's death were instrumental in generating an in many ways unique file, that sheds light on a little-known aspect of the life of the traders.

² It might have been the house of Kūn-ilum in Kanesh, which Ištar-lamassī as a widow (with young children) would have inherited, but the house is not mentioned in her last will. Elamma's archive contains the undated contract *210, in which Ištar-lamassī and (i.e. assisted by?) Aššur-ṭāb (presumably the son of Elamma) sell a house to Šalimma, the wife of Ir'am-Aššur and a daughter of Elamma, for 2½ minas of silver. This might be Kūn-ilum's house, sold within the family, either to raise money or because Ištar-lamassī had moved in with the new Anatolian husband, as *185:30 states.